3.2- Social Group

Learning Objectives

- Define the term groups and social groups
- Identify various types of groups and social groups like primary, secondary, In group, Out group etc.
- Differentiate between various types of social groups based on its characteristics
- Analyse how social groups influence individual behaviour and socialization

Learning Outcome

- Explain the meaning and significance of groups and social groups in social life
- Describe various types of groups and social groups
- Analyse different types of social groups in the real world scenarios
- Discuss the impact of a person membership in a social group on their personal growth and socialization

3.2- A- Group

Groups are everywhere in human life and are an indispensable part of the social world. The repeated interactions of members with each other make groups one of the strongest social units, which, due to their stability, not only survive changes but are also able to provide social life with the necessary continuity. Groups are important not only for single individuals, but also for the entire society. They meet the needs of their members and perform essential functions, such as socialization, without which a society cannot exist. However, groups can be a source of positive influence for their members, while at the same time, they can also increase the risk of being exposed to negative influences. Similarly, groups can play a positive role in shaping society or sometimes be a source of problems for it.

Definition And Meaning of Group

The word "group" is frequently mentioned, but it is rarely used with a clear understanding of its meaning. In common parlance, it can refer to broad social groups, such as family groups, kinship groups, ethnic or religious groups, professional groups, age or gender groups, larger communities, statistical aggregates, and other types of collectives. Even within the discipline of sociology, different scholars use the term differently. Sometimes it is used to refer to the entire human population, while in other cases, it refers to a smaller number of individuals, such as a dyad or a somewhat larger gathering. Because the term is used so widely and loosely, it is very problematic to come up with a single definition that encompasses all the possible meanings of a group.

Although most social work methods are based on a wealth of empirical knowledge, it is still difficult to give a single, unified definition of a group. Anderson and Parker provide a very comprehensive group definition, stating that "groups are units of two or more people who meet

in the same environment or who overcome distance by some means of communication, and who influence each other mentally. The distinctive relationship of the group is mutual interaction. Examples are friends in conversation, a committee in action, and children playing together."

The above definition basically emphasizes that the relationships between individuals in a group are not transient but recurrent and that each member is aware of the others. The members' shared understanding of being in a group influences their behaviour and distinguishes the group from a mere gathering. A group is therefore not just a physical collection of people, but a group of people who share common characteristics, engage in planned and ongoing interactions, and are aware of each other.

As stated, groups function as social units. People usually become members of a group to achieve a common goal, and they use interdependence and communication as the two most efficient means of achieving that goal. Therefore, a group is not just a collection of independent individuals but a unified social unit. On the other hand, an aggregate is simply a group of people who are in the same place, for example, passengers waiting for their flight at a departure gate at an airport. A good understanding of groups, their types and dimensions is a prerequisite for establishing group work in social work practice.

Three crucial points about groups are:

1. A group is a social unit, which is the basis of society and a real social phenomenon.

2. A group is composed of more than one individual.

3. Interaction between members is compulsory, thus social relationships are established.

Characteristics of Group

Groups are not just a collection of people in the same place; they are interdependent, interrelated entities that have common goals, perform agreed-upon tasks, and are organized. Generally, groups are the result of planning and purpose. It is essential to understand the key characteristics of groups as they help determine whether a gathering of people is truly a group. Although groups may have other characteristics in addition to those mentioned here, this brief overview sheds light on their nature and the workings of groups.

• Common goals: Groups exist to achieve a common goal. Groups are two or more people who come together to do something that would be difficult to do alone. Members work together because they believe that collective action will lead them to the goal.

• Interpersonal communication: The key feature that defines a group is that its members communicate with each other regularly over time. They talk to each other directly to exchange ideas, build relationships, and influence each other. Essentially, group members can communicate about tasks (planning, organizing, and doing group work to achieve shared goals) and relationships (developing and maintaining social ties among members).

• Shared identity: A group binds members together through a common social identity, and members use membership in a group to support and reinforce shared norms, values, attitudes,

and beliefs. At least two members identify as part of the group, and outsiders see them as a distinct social unit.

• Social interdependence: Members of a group are interdependent, meaning that the outcomes of an individual's actions are not only the determining factors for their outcomes, but also the actions of other group members. The key feature that distinguishes a group is the mutual interdependence between people in a group.

• Structure: A group is structured, so it has characteristics and members with certain roles, for example, a leader or a person responsible for sharing information. A structured group follows a code of conduct or agreed-upon standards, which ensures that members perform in an organized and purposeful manner.

Types of Group

Some groups can be distinguished as belonging to the private sphere of life, such as the family or a group, while others are from the public sphere, such as membership in clubs or political parties. Groups such as Punjabis, Bengalis, Malayalis, Indians, Hindus, Italians, Dalits or Muslims are examples of social groups based on ethnicity, nationality or religion. From a sociological perspective, these groups have quite different characteristics, which makes it possible to classify them into four main types.

- Aggregate

Aggregates are people who are physically close to each other, but who only meet for a short time, and who have no organization or meaningful social interaction. For example, people watching a fireworks display or a football match, a crowd, an audience, or passengers on the same bus can be considered aggregates. In such situations, since most of the members are strangers to each other, there is no meaningful interaction. These people have no common characteristics or a sense of belonging.

- Societal Group

A societal group is a group of people who share certain common values and interests and who feel a sense of solidarity. In fact, the main characteristic of a group is the recognition of membership. For example, there may be kinship, religious, linguistic or national groups - Chinese, Irish, Brahmins, Christians, Americans, Pakistanis, Tamils, Rajputs, Jats, Bengalis. Members identify themselves with these groups and accept them as having common characteristics. Despite the fact that they may be spread everywhere, the level of interaction between them may be very low, and the main bond that unites them is the feeling of belonging.

- Social Group

A social group is a group of people who share a common identity, a sense of unity, common goals, common norms, and a relatively high level of interaction. Examples include families, peer groups, sociology classes, social clubs, or neighbourhood groups. Members of the group interact regularly and engage in meaningful social interaction. In contrast to social groups, where members may only share a common identity or sense of belonging, and do not know each other personally and do not interact directly, social group refers to the quality and

continuity of interaction between members. Some sociologists consider social and community groups to be synonymous, however, the term social group as used here refers to the level and duration of interaction between members.

- Associational Group

An association group is a formally organized group with a defined structure. These groups have clearly formulated objectives, written rules, membership qualifications, established procedures, and a clear chain of authority. Examples include state and union governments, corporations, professional associations, labour unions, social clubs, political parties, and local panchayats. In contemporary complex societies, a large part of human interaction takes place in such association groups. Members, such as employees of a corporation or partners in a nationwide association, may not know each other personally, have common interests, and communicate using established channels.

Advantages of Groups:

• Groups often become a platform where people can discuss interests and tasks with each other, which leads directly to the improvement of results and overall performance. Therefore, teamwork is not only an important method, but also a key way for people to achieve their goals in various areas of activity such as businesses, schools, local communities.

• Groups are a source of inspiration for members to develop mutual support, exchange information and skills, and develop shared beliefs. Units such as families, religious groups, friendship circles, and voluntary organizations have a great influence on children's attitudes, values, and social norms.

• Furthermore, a person belonging to a particular group acquires more interpersonal skills, develops leadership qualities, gains greater self-awareness, and understands the importance of interdependence. Essentially, these are aspects of socialization that make not only the individual but also the community a better person.

• Groups can be seen as a way to cope with collective and personal challenges that are faced directly or indirectly, and as a reservoir of support. For example, talking about problems with friends, family, or colleagues usually provides new angles and solutions.

• In some situations, the combined efforts of groups may save money and time that cannot be achieved by working with individuals. These logistical advantages are very attractive to social scientists who use the focus group as their preferred data collection technique.

Disadvantages

• Although groups provide a platform for individuals to work towards common goals, they can still cause conflict within members. Disagreements and differences of opinion among members are common, and sometimes they can lead to further disputes.

• A major problem with a group is that it can be very difficult to achieve equality in participation, the reason behind this is that some members may take on activities such as decision-making and thereby exclude others.

• Keeping secrets in a group can be very difficult. The problem is particularly acute when dealing with people from the same community or social background, as they may be hesitant to share information openly for fear of being judged when their views or problems differ from those of others in the community.

• Sometimes the concerns of a group can override individual needs and concerns to such an extent that members are prevented from achieving their personal goals.

• Groups have the ability to change members, so that they can adopt ideas, attitudes, or even behaviours that can be dangerous not only for them but also for society.

• These variables must be taken into account in order to manage groups properly, which will lead to positive results for all members.

Conclusion

A group refers to a collection of individuals or objects that form a unit. In sociology, it is a term that defines a human community that engages in different types of interactions. From the very beginning, people are organized into certain groups, such as family, gender, or social class. Membership in groups can be voluntary, involuntary, or both, and usually, each person is a member of more than one group. For example, a person may be a member of a college group, a sports team, a friendship group, a religious group, or a workplace. At the same time, people may be part of groups without their knowledge or consent as a result of factors such as caste, tribe, income, or education. Membership in groups deeply affects a person's identity, values, perceptions, and life experiences.

3.2- B- Social Groups

Introduction

People in society do not live in isolation from each other. They need each other to share not only problems, but also ideas and experiences. Humans need friendship, which is why they are often called social animals. Although society is an abstraction - it cannot be seen directly, but can only be understood through the presence and operation of social norms that guide and shape behaviour - the concept of 'group' is important.

Social groups are the primary units in which people exist, develop their lives, and engage in meaningful interactions. We live in groups such as families, and belong to larger groups such as clans and races. This is why sociologists often define sociology as the study of social groups.

Definition

- MacIver:- “By group, we mean any collection of human beings who are brought into social relationship with one another”

- Bottomore:- “A social group is an aggregate of individuals in which (i) definite relations exist between the individuals comprising it, and (ii) each individual is conscious of the group itself and its symbols”
- Ogburn and Nimkoff :- “Whenever two or more individuals come together and influences one another they may be said to constitute Social Group”
- Robert K. Merton:- “A social group is a number of people who define themselves as members of a group; who expect certain behaviour from members that they do not expect from outsiders and whom others define as belonging to a group”
- Harry M Johnson;- “A social group is a system of social interaction”
- Marshal Jones:- “social group is 'two or more people between whom there is an established pattern of interaction”
- Emory S Bogardus:- “social group as 'a number of persons, two or more, who have common objects of attention, who are stimulating to each other, who have common loyalty and participate in similar activities”
- Eldredge and Merrill:- “A social group may be defined as two or more persons who are in communication over an appreciable period of time and who act in accordance with a contact, function or purpose”

Characteristics of social groups

The characteristics of social groups can be easily inferred from their definitions and descriptions:

 Collection of individuals: Social groups are basically collections of individuals who are organized. These individuals inherently feel a sense of unity and cohesion, even in the absence of a specific goal. Just as organisms such as colleges cannot function without students and teachers, social groups cannot exist without people. Unlike a crowd or a sect, it is more stable and long-lasting. It symbolizes a community of individuals who are connected through interpersonal relationships. Some sociologists describe groups as the “social bricks” of society. This suggests that groups form the foundation of society, just as bricks form the foundation of a building.

 Interaction among members: Interaction between members is a fundamental condition, since mere coexistence cannot be considered a group. The latter in fact represents a network of social interactions, the limit of which is where these interactions end.

 Mutual awareness: Mutual recognition among members is equally important, through which each recognizes and adapts to their behaviour; Giddings calls this interaction "a conscious of kindness".

 We feeling: A "we-feeling" or sense of togetherness characterizes social groups, whereby members identify themselves with the group, thus creating sympathy, cooperation, and collective defense of shared interests. Their actions are governed by rules and norms, and members are always aware of their roles, although they share a common sense that emerges from their collective interactions.

 Group unity and solidarity: The cohesion and unity of the group arise from the ties that bind the members. The degree of cohesion of a group depends largely on the frequency of meetings of its members, the types of these meetings, and the emotional aspect that these meetings entail. Groups such as families, circles of friends, or religious communities are likely to be highly cohesive because the members share multiple common interests, engage in frequent social relationships, and exhibit strong loyalty and morale. This sense of unity is often maintained through the conscious and deliberate efforts of the members.

 Common interests: Most groups are formed based on common interests and goals. People join or form groups to achieve certain goals, and the nature of a group is a reflection of the interests that unite its members. As a result, groups can be of many different types, including political, religious, economic, educational, racial, and national groups, each of which is the result of the shared goals of its members.

 Similar behaviour: Group members are likely to behave similarly when they work toward the same shared goals. Social groups, in particular, as collective entities, exhibit collective behaviour, which is a set of coordinated actions and responses by their members.

 Group norms: Every group has rules or norms that it has established for itself. The activities of the group are always governed by certain rules and norms that all members accept and follow. Members of the group are aware of their roles, actions, and the collective consciousness that results from their shared interactions. Groups also have provisions for correcting or punishing members who violate these norms.

 Group size: Every social group, whether formal or informal, has a concept of size, which can vary considerably. A small group may be a unit of just two individuals, such as a husband and wife, while a political party may consist of hundreds of thousands of members. The size of a group has a great influence on the nature and functioning of the group.

 Groups are dynamic: The evolution of social groups is a continuous process, and therefore, they should be viewed as dynamic rather than static. People die or leave the group, new members are added, and groups respond to changes in their internal or external environment. Sometimes, the reason for which a group was created in the first place may change, hence, the need for flexibility to adapt.

 Stability: The stability and duration of groups can vary. Some groups, such as crowds, mobs, and audiences, are temporary and short-lived in nature, while others may be very stable and stable, remaining firm in their structure and identity over time.

 Influence on personality: Social groups assimilate the process of personality development with their members and, at the same time, provide members with the opportunity to express their individual characteristics and personality.

 Multiple participation: Each individual is a member of one or more groups, e.g. his/her family, peer group, neighbourhood, or clubs. These groups are where people interact and often share similar goals or participate in similar activities. For example, a cricket team is one type of group, while a political party is another.

 Identification by name: Most groups have specific names by which they are known and referred to.

 Distinct culture, language, and symbols: Each group has its own norms of behaviour, different ways of interacting, and specific language or symbols for communication.

Importance of social groups

The study of human society is essentially the study of its social groups. There are countless types and varieties of society, and just as no man can exist without society, no society can exist without groups. Groups are the foundation of the human race; it is a fact of life that people, whether they know it or not, live in groups, whether they do so of their own free will or not, whether they do so willingly or unwillingly. It is through interactions in groups of different kinds that the human race lives and is governed largely.

- ❖ Survival Without Groups

Groups are so fundamental to human existence that without them one's survival becomes problematic and life-threatening. These groups are the main factor behind the process of developing human abilities, characteristics, and nature as a whole. Man is born with the biological prerequisite to be a fully social being, and it is in groups that he is given the environment in which these biological potentials are developed and displayed.

- ❖ Only in humans does man become human

The development of man into a fully realized individual occurs only in a social environment. The scientific evidence and reality behind historical cases such as Kaspar Hauser, the two children Kamala and her sister who were found in a wolf's den, and Anna, an American child who was left alone for over five years - point to the fact that human qualities cannot develop without contact with other human beings. Humans, although biologically capable of being social beings, still need interaction to express their abilities. Since infants' dependency extends from the very beginning, it naturally places them in the most primary social group: the family, which represents the first sphere of learning and human growth.

- ❖ Groups that help social survival

In addition to survival, people need groups to lead successful and meaningful lives. By continuously practicing social life with each other, individuals not only become acquainted with experiences; they also observe the behaviours of others and make their own improvements through imitation. In addition to following the methods learned from past experiences, they constantly try to be wary of past mistakes by abandoning them. From birth to death, the human race is immersed in socialization - the process of waning human development - thanks to which an individual's personality is formed, and thus, the individual becomes a fully functioning member of society.

- ❖ Groups contribute to personality development

Personality is a social phenomenon that comes from collective experience, because the individual's unique personality is still dependent on the social environment. There is no

development of identity that occurs in complete solitude. Social groups give people the opportunity to reveal their deepest nature, talents, and abilities, which helps to bring hidden potential to light. They play a role in shaping a person's beliefs, morals, ideals, and, moreover, the basis of a person's character. Emotional maturity, cognitive growth, and the satisfaction of physical and social needs are closely related to one's participation in groups. Essentially, groups are the core of human growth, and humans cannot be separated from the social groups of which they are a part.

Conclusion

A social group is a group of people who come together on the basis of common interests or by sharing a common goal. While some groups arise naturally, other groups are formed with a specific goal in mind. Real groups imply a certain degree of social cohesion and go beyond the concept of a group of individuals. People who are members of a group usually have some common characteristics, such as interests, values, cultural traditions, family ties, or social identity.

A social group is a social unit characterized by the following essential characteristics:

a) A collection of two or more individuals

b) Established relationships among its members,

c) Mutual awareness or shared consciousness.

Since a group is composed of individuals who interact with each other, the mode of interaction may be different, and membership can be achieved in many ways. As a result, social groups may differ in nature. Different scholars have explored and analyzed the concept of groups from different angles and have proposed different types of classifications as a result. People are divided into groups based on a number of factors, including their roles, size, stability, status, membership rules, and level of interaction.

3.2- C- Types of social groups

Different types of groups make up society, and they may have similarities but also differences. Some groups, such as children following the family model, form naturally, while others, such as a cricket club formed by people who come together to play, emerge gradually and by chance.

The number of groups is very large, and their diversity is enormous. Groups vary in size, while their number in any given society is immeasurable. In fact, the total number of groups is greater than the number of individuals, since each individual belongs to several groups. To deal with them systematically, scientific classification is necessary. Different sociologists have proposed different criteria for classifying groups.

Criteria for classification

Any field classification usually depends on some criteria, and social groups are no exception. However, unlike some fields where only one factor is sufficient, social groups are classified according to several criteria. Sociologists have classified groups according to different factors,

such as race, religion, region, form of government, size, caste, gender, age, class, occupation, kinship, degree of organization, type of social interaction, scope, stability, and mobility of group interests. A classification can be based on one criterion or on several factors. It is important to note that these classifications are not completely separate and, in practice, they often overlap.

The way groups function within a society reflects the way the society is structured. The level of closeness between members and the frequency of their interactions largely determine the group category to which they belong.

MacIver and Page categorize groups on the following basis:

1. **Size** – Groups may be small or large depending on the number of members.
2. **Quality of Social Interaction** – The level and nature of interaction among members varies across groups.
3. **Degree of Intimacy** – Some groups are marked by close, personal relationships while others have more impersonal ties.
4. **Range of Group Interests** – Groups differ in the scope of interests they pursue, from narrow to wide-ranging.
5. **Duration of Interests** – Some groups exist for a short period while others continue for long durations.
6. **Degree of Organization** – Groups may be loosely structured or highly organized with defined roles and rules.

A) Classification by George Simmel

German sociologist Georg Simmel used size as a criterion to distinguish different social groups. **Small groups** are like dyads (two members), triads (three members), and other small groups, where one can say that the members have a more personal and direct relationship with each other. **Large groups**, therefore, refer to all broader groups, such as ethnic groups, political organizations, nations, and other extended social groups, where the relationship between members is less personal and more formal.

B) Classification by Sanderson

Sociologist Dwight Sanderson proposed three types of social groups for classification purposes, which have different structures and are therefore divided into voluntary, involuntary, and representative groups.

• **Involuntary groups** are those into which people are born, such as families. One cannot choose membership - for example, no man can decide which family he is born into.

• **Voluntary groups** are those into which a person becomes a member of his own free will. Members are free to participate and can terminate their membership at any time - as in clubs or associations.

• **Delegated groups** are made up of individuals who come only as representatives of others - they are either elected or appointed by a special authority. The best example of this type of group is a parliament.

The classification here illustrates the ways in which people become members of different types of groups, whether by birth, election, or representation.

C) Classification by CH Cooley

Cooley's division of groups into primary, secondary-based on the intimacy level of social contact-is one of the most frequently referred to ideas in sociology.

i) Primary Group

The concept of primary groups was first introduced by C.H. Cooley in his landmark work *"Social Organization: Human Nature and Social Order"*. Cooley used the term primary group to represent a close-knit social group that shares values, has the same norms of behaviour, and has frequent direct and personal contacts.

For C.H. Cooley, primary groups are characterized by close, face-to-face interaction and cooperation among members. In such groups, few people have direct contact with each other, which supports them, provides them with companionship, and gives them the opportunity to share their own life experiences. Such groups are usually limited in size, and each person is a member of at least one primary group. They are called primary because they have a very significant influence on the social behaviour and ideals of an individual. Due to their essential function, primary groups are central to social organization.

Cooley went on to say that the feeling of belonging to such groups strongly unites members, and they naturally begin to see themselves not as separate individuals, but as a collective "we" or "us". Cooley said that some examples in which members of primary groups can be found are family, friends at school, neighbourhood and community groups, or groups of elderly people. He strictly stated that these groups are the basis of social processes in all societies, in all eras, and at all stages of social development.

In his opinion, in any group, there are at least some elements of primary relationships. These types of relationships create a foundation for cohesion and strengthen the feeling of "we" of the members. In these groups, individuals are spiritually united, and they direct their efforts towards achieving that collective feeling. Primary groups are often called "we-groups" because they promote the development of qualities such as empathy, mutual recognition, and common membership, and the word "we" is the most natural way to capture their essence.

Three elements or conditions are necessary for the formation of a primary group:

• Members must be in direct contact with each other.

In order for closeness to develop between members of a group, it is necessary to establish that the parties involved are physically close to each other and that this closeness is best achieved through face-to-face interaction. By directly contacting each other, talking to each other, and

looking for each other, it is easier to exchange not only ideas, but also feelings, perspectives, and emotions. Such closeness contributes to the opportunities that can be used to form primary groups and creates the most favourable conditions for this formation.

• Group size should be small to facilitate personal relationships

The size of a group has a great influence on the nature of the relationships among its members. If the number of people is too large, real sensual contact is not possible, so small groups lead to greater intimacy and more personal communication is possible. The smaller the group, the closer the relationships become. As the groups get larger, the fewer relationships there are and the more individual personality becomes.

Primary groups

Example:- **family, children's playgroups, close friendship circles, and traditional neighbourhoods**.

These groups are characterized by:

- **Sense of belonging** – members feel they are an integral part of the group.
- **Emotional warmth** – interactions are marked by care, support, and affection.
- **Cooperation** – members work together and support one another's needs.
- **"We" feeling** – a strong group identity that fosters loyalty and mutual identification.

• Long-term relationships that ensure the stability and longevity of relationships.

The extent of intimacy in a group depends on the frequency and intensity of interaction between its members. The more people do the same thing, the stronger their bond becomes. The regular and consistent sharing of habits and ideas among the same people makes these social bonds stronger.

Characteristics of Primary Groups

Key characteristic features of a primary group include:

1- Dominance of Face-to-Face Relations

The primary groups focus on the intimate, close, and direct, relationships between the members. Individuals in such groups interact personally and are familiar not only with each other's names but also with each other's backgrounds, occupations, statuses, and even the personal qualities. Such direct contacts help individuals to become more intimate and to share their emotional feelings with each other. The face-to-face relations are mostly found in small groups like the family, kids' playgroup, peer circle, and neighbourhood, where personal association is natural and frequent.

Character of Primary Relations

(a) Identity of ends: Members of primary groups have similar desires, attitudes, and goals, which allows them to cooperate harmoniously towards common goals. Their common perspectives, mutual concern, and strong unity with the group create identity.

(b) Relationship as an end in itself: Relationships in primary groups are valued for their own sake, not for external benefits. These relationships, such as love between spouses or friendships, are deeply meaningful, self-sufficient, and provide inner satisfaction beyond personal interests.

(c) The relationship is personal: In primary groups, relationships are based on individuals, not the roles they play. These personal and immutable relationships exist because of the people involved, and they cease to exist if one person is removed.

(d) The relationship is inclusive: Members see each other as complete individuals and understand each other deeply. This close understanding fosters intimacy, trust, and a strong sense of unity among members.

(e) The relationship is spontaneous: Relationships in primary groups form naturally and spontaneously, without formal contracts or agreements. They arise spontaneously from genuine emotional connections, as seen in friendships, family relationships, marriages, and children's play relationships.

2- Small Size

Primary groups are small in size. Because the number of members in the group is limited, each member can participate closely and effectively in group activities. As the size decreases, the level of intimacy increases proportionally and personal relationships become increasingly stronger. As a group grows larger, the relationships that characterize the group change and the intimacy and personal interaction that characterize primary group interactions tend to diminish.

3- Physical proximity or Nearness

Face-to-face contact between members is possible only when they live in close proximity to each other, often in the same area, and more or less permanently. The frequent opportunities to see and talk to each other facilitate the exchange of ideas, opinions, and feelings. In a way, actions such as cuddling, kissing, eating, living together, playing, traveling, or studying together become external signs of inner unity. In this way, physical proximity becomes a necessary condition for the development and survival of primary groups.

4- Stability of the group

A primary group is usually of a stable nature. It is a general rule that the longer a group stays together, the stronger and deeper the bonds between its members become. The longer they stay together, the stronger their social bonds become. For example, a husband and wife may have had quarrels for years, but the fact that they have lived together for so long makes it difficult for them to separate and live without each other.

5- Similarity of background

Members of a primary group usually come from similar backgrounds and have gone through similar experiences. A certain level of common understanding and compatibility is necessary because then each individual is both a contributor and a beneficiary to the group. If one member's position, knowledge, or experience is at a much higher or lower level than others, it may hinder group participation. Whether in the family, playgroup, or peer circle, the importance of such similarity in terms of smooth interpersonal interaction cannot be underestimated.

6. Limited self-interest:

Those in a primary group will prioritize the needs of the group over their own individual needs. The effect of having common goals is that it helps to control personal desires, thereby providing members with emotional satisfaction and fulfillment.

7. Intensity of shared interest:

The mutual interests of a primary group are the main source of strong ties between members. These shared issues not only become more important, but also become collective, thus gaining broad support and stability. As a result, a phenomenon such as primary groups is very common, they exist for a long time, and are the source of the soul of living together.

8. Communication:

If we consider primary groups such as a family or a children's playgroup, we can say that communication there is easy, straightforward, and productive. Communication carried out in the presence makes the mutual exchange of thoughts and feelings a quick and simple process.

9. Unspecialized nature:

Primary groups are not the result of conscious planning, nor are they created to fulfill a specific function. On the contrary, they are directed towards a large range of shared interests and concerns, and therefore their nature is very broad and unspecialized.

10. Direct cooperation:

The members of a primary group cooperate directly with each other to realize their common interests. Their work is not independent or interdependent, but collective. Unlike complex industrial societies with a formal division of labour, in this case, work is mainly a way of sharing experiences, and the group is considered a single entity in carrying out its activities.

Importance of Primary Groups

Primary groups are very valuable not only for the individual but also for the entire society. They are the main sources for obtaining the first education about cultural norms and preparing people to lead a successful social life. These groups have a great influence on human socialization and their personality development. Moreover, some primary groups can offer you some material benefits such as better wages, better productivity, higher worker morale, and more opportunities for counselling and guidance.

The primary group is the most essential human factor. The family is the child's immediate primary group from birth, and it is the first place for socialization that the child receives. The family, along with peer groups and neighbourhoods, helps to build the child's personality by providing social norms, values, morals, beliefs, and cultural practices. Through continuous guidance and interaction, the child's natural impulses are slowly transformed into socially acceptable behaviour.

☺ **Personality development:** Primary groups, with the family at the forefront, are the main influencers in the formation of human personality. These are the groups that lay the foundation for our understanding of fundamental values such as love, justice, and freedom. The attitudes and behaviours that a person learns in infancy through primary groups, such

as living in fairness, equality, free expression, cooperation, and willingness to sacrifice for the group, become lifelong influences. Primary groups shape our thoughts, guide our emotions, influence our actions, and largely determine our loyalties. Unlike groups that form solely for work or recreation, primary groups are places where we experience love, belonging, and personal growth.

- ☺ **Satisfaction of psychological needs:** Primary groups are responsible for meeting various psychological needs of individuals. They become a source of psychological comfort, emotional security, and happiness. By providing empathy, sympathy, and facilitating the exchange of thoughts and feelings, these groups become a means of alleviating mental and emotional stress and tension. Members of primary groups find their closest and most loyal friends there and see them as the main focus of true human love, care, and affection.
- ☺ **Provide encouragement:** The primary group not only provides satisfaction and pleasure to its members, but also encourages them to pursue their dreams. The feeling of a common goal and collective action brings a spirit of confidence and courage, so that people are motivated to work hard and persevere. The thought that others are also dedicated to the same goals energizes members to show more effort and dedication.
- ☺ **Unity in process:** There are strong bonds of unity within a primary group, which basically stand for the direct cooperation of its members. Each of them is involved in common activities, thus making the group a place for a shared experience of life. Such unity in action meets the physical and psychological needs of its members, and as a result, the group has a better chance of coping with crises due to its strong internal ties.
- ☺ **Contributes to the development of democratic attitudes:** On the other hand, primary groups provide individuals with many essential social functions. They play a crucial role in shaping the core attitudes of individuals towards their fellow beings, social institutions and the world. The individual gradually develops in these groups the qualities of love, kindness, empathy, tolerance, mutual assistance and willingness to sacrifice, which become the binding force of social structures on a small scale. Such qualities contribute to the appreciation of democracy and freedom, and primary groups are the place where democratic attitudes are not only born, but also developed and strengthened.
- ☺ **Functions as a social control agent:** From a social perspective, primary groups are important elements of social control, acting as a system that provides security and support to members. In addition to providing security and support to members, they also advise, guide, and monitor their behaviour and relationships. Family, local community, peer groups, and friendship circles as institutions are the main actors that oversee and influence the developments of members.

Limits of Primary Groups

At a basic level, primary groups are supportive and loving, although they are also more likely to experience competition, assertiveness, and heated arguments. Emotions are socialized through empathy and, therefore, are usually governed by the general mood of the group. People can be one way or another, in that they can be ambitious, but their dreams of achieving a place in society are what truly fuel their ambitions.

However, the idea of a primary group cannot be limited to the characteristics of being small and close-knit. Only in the following ways:

- ✭ Smallness and closeness alone do not help to transform a three-member student committee formed to organize an activity into a primary group. An example would be a primary group that does not exist because it exists for a specific purpose and is disbanded after the task.
- ✭ Similarly, the protagonist behind the formation of an intimate but transactional prostitute-client relationship cannot be a primary group because of the transient and specific nature of the relationship.

Therefore, primary groups are those with long-lasting, loving, and personally significant relationships rather than being small or close.

Although primary groups and primary ties together serve as the backbone of society, they are not always the most favourable modes of social interaction. Sometimes primary groups have the potential to disrupt social processes. For example, primary ties can be a hindrance when objective decision-making is involved. The dysfunctional result could be that a teacher is biased by giving a student a high grade that he or she does not deserve, thereby making the teacher's behaviour unethical.

In today's society, there are many situations in which primary relationships can become inappropriate or harmful. In large, bureaucratic organizations where work is routine, impersonal interactions are often more appropriate than intimate interactions, spontaneity is overshadowed by routine, and a clear division of labour is required rather than a variety of roles. Societies or sub-societies with dense networks of primary relationships are likely to be more tolerant of differences, resistant to change, and less liberal than those with more casual relationships.

In addition, primary groups exert power over their members through restrictions, expectations, and social pressures. For example, a family may grant a member certain freedoms and impose limitations, and a peer group may promote conformity among its members by encouraging it. Primary groups may be reluctant to accept changes in the areas of intelligence, industry, and education as a means of maintaining their traditional and ancestral relationships.

ii) Secondary group

A secondary group is usually small enough to allow for personal, direct contact between members, but it is not very common or deep. Members of such groups have limited relationships with each other, usually developed through experimentation or through their mutual self-interest. A typical member of such a group influences other members only indirectly, because he/she does not know any other member personally. Most interactions are impersonal and take place through indirect means, such as writing, rather than direct communication. Any group that does not have close, intimate, emotionally involved relationships, unlike primary groups, is a secondary group. Therefore, secondary groups are usually described as less intimate, personal, and inclusive groups, whose members interact indirectly.

Unlike primary groups, secondary groups are mostly impersonal and focused on achieving certain goals. They include all non-primary social groups, and therefore form a residual category commonly referred to as "special interest groups". Secondary groups have become almost inevitable in modern society due to increasing cultural and social complexity.

Primary groups are groups that are usually found in simple societies where social life can be managed quite easily. As populations increase and societies expand their territories, interests become more diverse, and thus secondary or impersonal relationships emerge. At the same time, specialized knowledge and skills are required, while individual members often do not have the time, energy, or proper qualifications to handle everything personally. These characteristics characterize the modern nation, as well as large corporations, churches, factories, armies, labour unions, universities, and nationwide political parties - all of which are examples of secondary groups.

Characteristics of Secondary Groups

- **Dominance of secondary relations:** Secondary groups have the characteristic features of impersonal, indirect, non-inclusive, and contractual relationships. These relationships are indirect because of the large size of the group and the dispersed members. They are contractual in the sense that relationships in the group are guided by specific interests, goals, rights, duties, and obligations aimed at achieving collective goals. Relationships are impersonal because members focus primarily on their own interests rather than on personal relationships with others. Moreover, these relationships are non-inclusive because they are limited and partial in nature. Such features are characteristic of large organizations such as factories, corporations, government offices, banks, universities, political parties, trade unions, and international associations.
- **Largeness of the size:** Secondary groups are generally much larger in size than primary groups. Some of these organizations include cities, nations, political parties, trade unions, corporations, and international associations such as the Rotary Club and the Lions Club. The number of members in these groups can range from thousands to hundreds of thousands, and in some cases, there is no upper limit to membership.
- **Membership:** In secondary groups, membership is largely a matter of choice, so individuals are free to join or leave at any time. Political parties, international associations such as the Rotary Club or Lions Club, and business corporations are some good examples. On the other hand, in some secondary groups, such as the state, membership is essentially voluntary.
- **No physical basis:** Secondary groups are not defined as those that are physically close to each other. Some of them even transcend geographical boundaries, as their members are often spread out over vast distances. These organizations, such as the Rotary Club or the Lions Club, are almost global in scope, and they connect members who live in different regions.
- **Specific ends or interests:** These are secondary groups that are formed to achieve certain goals or to serve certain interests, which is why they are often called "special interest groups." Members participate primarily because the group helps them greatly in achieving these specific goals.

- **Indirect communication:** In a secondary group, interactions and communications are mostly indirect. Members use different media facilities such as radio, telephone, television, newspapers, magazines, and mail to communicate. Since communication is indirect, it may take longer to complete and may not be as effective. Impersonal relationships in these groups are a result of the limitation of direct contact, and are also a reason for this to occur among members.
- **Nature of group control:** Informal social control mechanisms, such as moral persuasion or peer pressure in secondary groups, are ineffective in controlling the behavior of members. Instead, formal mechanisms, such as laws, legislation, police, and courts, play a major role in ensuring law and order. Individual behaviour is dependent on public opinion, propaganda, legal regulations, and political ideologies, which are their primary sources of guidance and constraint.
- **Group structure:** Secondary groups usually have an organized and formal structure. They have a designated authority and a clear division of labour. The role and duty of each member are seen as binding the group as a whole. Members may have different statuses, distinctions based on caste, colour, religion, region, class, or language are not rigid, and there is generally more tolerance of others both within and outside the group.
- **Limited influence on personality:** Secondary groups are special groups in which individuals have limited participation. Since members usually spend more time in primary groups, these groups have relatively little influence on their personality.

Importance of Secondary Groups

In modern, industrialized, and urbanized societies, our secondary groups have become very important. Although we can basically say that primary groups were the main social units that served human needs, it is a fact that increasing urban life, population, complex social structures, and diverse interests have made the emergence of secondary groups inevitable. In this regard, the study of social groups has been influenced by both of these processes, and as a result, simple face-to-face groups are often not enough to meet people's needs. Thus, secondary groups have replaced primary groups in many social areas.

The major changes brought about by the Industrial Revolution, scientific and technological advances, and the emergence of new political and religious ideologies have been reflected in modern society. Their influence has spread to people's attitudes, interests, tastes, needs, and even beliefs. In turn, these changes have led to the formation of numerous secondary groups whose main goal is to meet the needs of a constantly changing society. People are becoming aware of the number and diversity of such groups, and both sides are growing; in addition, people are becoming increasingly dependent on these groups for their social, economic, and cultural needs.

There are many secondary groups that significantly determine and shape our lives today. The presence of these modern social structures often leaves individuals with no choice but to join a secondary group. Take the example of a factory worker, who may be forced to register with a trade union in order to have his rights and interests protected. Nowadays, secondary groups

have spread their branches to all spheres of life, namely politics, economics, commerce, industry, religion, education, culture, etc.

In today's world, secondary groups are more prevalent than primary groups. Most of our initiatives and achievements are through secondary groups. These groups are a platform for our personal growth and the expression of our talents, while at the same time, they use and control our energy. The attitudes, ideas, and ideologies we hold are to some extent the result of these groups. In today's society, it is common for people to form smaller primary groups within the framework of larger secondary groups.

People have recently shown a tendency to be more loyal and committed to larger secondary groups than to smaller ones. Many of the characteristics commonly thought of as primary group qualities, such as sacrifice, helpfulness, cooperation, dedication, empathy, and fair play, can now also be found in secondary groups. Some examples of such loyalty and other similar feelings expressed in secondary groups include: political party membership, religious organization participation, patriotism toward the nation, social responsibility, identification with a trade union, and military loyalty.

Differences between Primary Groups and Secondary Groups

Primary Groups	Secondary Groups
These are groups marked by close, face-to-face relationships, mutual support, and companionship.	These groups are larger, more formal, and lack the intimacy found in primary groups.
Members share intimate and personal connections.	They are usually organized around specific interests or objectives, and interaction among members tends to be impersonal and goal-oriented.
Examples include family, neighbourhood, local community, children’s playgroups, and local brotherhoods.	Examples include political parties, trade unions, religious associations, the state, cities, corporations, factories, Rotary Club, and Lions Club.
Social relations in primary groups are direct, face-to-face, intimate, non-specialised, non-partisan, and not primarily economic in nature.	Social relations in secondary groups are indirect, non-intimate, contractual, specialised, often partisan, and largely economic in nature.
These groups are small in size and usually confined to a specific, localised area, allowing close interaction among members.	These groups are relatively large and are not limited to any particular geographical area.
Communication is direct, quick, and efficient because members are physically close.	Communication is mostly indirect and slower, as members are dispersed over a wide area.

Members share general, common interests and are concerned with the welfare of all members.	Members have specific, focused interests, so these groups are often referred to as “special interest groups.”
The structure is informal, with no rigid rules, formal roles, or detailed organization. Members are not concerned with rights, powers, or status.	The structure is formal, with clearly defined rules, roles, rights, and responsibilities. The organization is carefully planned and regulated
These groups are relatively stable and durable, often lasting for long periods.	These groups can be either temporary or permanent, depending on their purpose and context.
They exert strong control over members’ behaviour, primarily through informal means such as norms, customs, and mutual expectations	They have limited control over members’ behaviour, relying more on formal mechanisms like laws, rules, and regulations to maintain order.
They strongly regulate members’ behaviour, mainly through informal social controls such as norms, values, and mutual expectations.	They have limited influence on members’ behaviour, so formal mechanisms like laws, rules, and regulations are necessary to maintain control.

Classification of groups by Feeling

W. G. Sumner, in his work “Folkways”, classified social groups based on sentiment, namely "in-groups" and "out-groups".

- In-groups: Such groups depict the interaction of members with a sense of unity and support. People identify themselves as members of these groups, such as family, friends, or peer groups. In-groups, in general, judge out-groups by their cultural norms, thus creating a sense of racial superiority or inferiority. For example, the upper caste and lower caste communities in a village may each consider themselves to be separate in-groups and each other to be out-groups. They are the "we" groups, representing the insiders.
- Out-groups: Groups to which an individual is not a part and to which he/she may have some form of prejudice are called out-groups. Such prejudice may take the form of a feeling of superiority/inferiority. Examples of out-groups include members of the opposite sex, other families, or foreign nations. Outside groups are called "in-groups."

We can simply say that an in-group is an “us-group” and an out-group is an “them-group”. The difference mainly depends on the subjective perspective of an individual, which depends on his/her tendency to identify with a particular group for a particular reason in a particular situation. In-groups and out-groups can be as large as entire nations. Generally, identifying with an in-group leads to strengthening qualities such as solidarity, cooperation, and collective identity, especially if the conflict is with an out-group. Example: Indians displayed strong national pride during the Kargil crisis, thus demonstrating in-group loyalty at the national level.

D) Classification of Groups by Structure (Sorokin)

Pitirim A Sorokin classified social groups into two, namely Horizontal groups and Vertical groups.

- Horizontal groups: These are groups formed by people who know each other well and who function socially on a hierarchical basis. For example, a circle of friends or peer groups. Even small groups such as economic classes may function as horizontal groups, giving them status and rank within society.
- Vertical groups: These are groups of people who understand and accept the hierarchical structure of their interaction. Social classes, castes, and bureaucracies are some examples. In India, the caste system has been a major cause of the formation of vertical group structures. In addition to the systems of social class, religion, and politics, there are larger vertical structures that accept the world as one large human family.

Vertical groups include members from different social backgrounds, while horizontal groups include individuals who belong primarily to a single social class. To illustrate, occupational groups such as doctors or electricians typically belong to a specific social class, while religious groups may include members from different social classes.

E) Classification of groups by Organizational Structure

organized groups and Unorganized groups

Social groups can be divided into two categories based on whether they have the extent of an organizational structure: organized and unorganized forms. Some groups may exhibit a defined and systematic organizational framework, while others may operate without a structural basis. The former are considered organized groups and the latter are considered unorganized groups.

Organized Groups

Organized groups are generally called association groups. These groups come into existence through a formally structured process called "organization." Here, "organization" is not a socially broad organizational concept, nor is it seen as a management bureaucracy; rather, it refers to the systematic structure of associations. The process of organization is a very distinctive feature of today's world.

 Element of Organization: In modern, complex societies, a large part of social relations and interactions occur within organized groups. Ogburn and Nimkoff have pointed out that an organization, along with the “active mechanism,” is the main instrument for achieving collective goals. It provides an interface between individuals, assigns social statuses to individuals, assigns roles to them, and regulates relationships by specifying patterns of authority and obedience. In a way, the organization stabilizes and perpetuates the group, thus ensuring its long-term survival. It is precisely this constituent institution that enables people to play a significant role in different groups, thus making social life structured and practical.

 Size of groups: Organized groups can range from small groups such as families, neighborhoods, and children's playgroups to large groups such as political parties, trade unions,

and international associations. These groups may operate in a local context or be geographically widespread.

 Nature of social ties: Social ties within structured groups can be of various types - they can be personal or impersonal, intimate or non-intimate, direct or indirect, exclusive or non-exclusive, contractual or non-contractual, and economic or non-economic. Accordingly, all primary groups and most secondary groups fall into the category of organized groups.

 Group durability: Organized groups tend to have a higher durability rate than other types of groups. They are not temporary or transient. Through this durability, members of such groups can achieve their specific goals more efficiently, thereby creating a cooperative spirit among them to achieve common goals. Unity is further strengthened through the identity of mutual interests and thus the feeling of belonging to the group develops.

 Group structure: The framework of organized groups can be as simple as in a family community or as complex as in modern business enterprises and industries. These groups can be formal or informal. In terms of social relationships, they can be formal and specific, as in trade unions or political parties, or informal and non-specific, as in friends clubs, children's playgroups, peer groups, and cliques.

Moreover, organized groups may be subdivided into institutional and non-institutional, territorial and non-territorial, voluntary and involuntary, in-groups and out-groups as well. The modern civilized communities consist of numerous such organized groups.

Unorganized Groups

Unorganized groups are social groups that lack the characteristic of organization. They do not have a clearly defined pattern of social interaction; rather, their interactions are uncertain, uncertain, disorderly, and unpredictable. Such groups are not the result of deliberate creation, careful planning, or systematic effort. They come into being suddenly or spontaneously and exist for a short period of time. They are not formed on the basis of shared needs or planned goals. Examples of unorganized groups include crowds, mobs, crowds, and the public.

Unorganized groups are temporary, however, they have attracted the attention of sociologists because they are so frequent in society. These groups usually become manifestations of the strongest and deepest human attitudes. In addition, their unexpected, irrational, and often criminal behavior is determined by a particular social organization, institutional structures, cultural norms, and social divisions at a given time and place, so, in a way, unorganized groups have become a subject not only for sociologists, but also for political scientists and social psychologists. A greater understanding of their nature can be gained through the study of the main examples of unorganized groups, the crowd and the public.

Crowd as an Unorganized Group

As a social group, a crowd is the lowest category of unorganized groups. It defines the smallest social unit of a group or society consisting of more or less the same number of people who share the same focus, in a specific place, for a limited time. A crowd is usually a short-lived,

temporary, even chaotic social group of humans. The definition of such a group and the main characteristics of a crowd can be represented in a table as follows:

Characteristics of a Crowd:

1. Physical presence. A crowd is a group of people who are physically present in a given place and who visibly respond to a particular point of attention. For example, people standing in line at a theater to buy tickets, people crowding a fish market, or people gathering on the side of a road to see a circus or hear a speech are examples of such people.

2. Spontaneous and temporary. The formation of a crowd is always a new, surprising, and fleeting event. Let us consider just one example, which is a circus on a road, where people gather to watch it. After the show is over, the road is empty.

3. Lack of structure: A crowd is characterized by undefined leadership, goals, social norms, and unplanned activities. The interactions of members are random and uncoordinated.

4. Accidental formation: In a crowd situation, people come together by chance. For example, a car accident, an act of immorality, a fire drill, a fight between people, or a house fire may cause people to stop what they are doing and look around. It makes them feel oriented in the same way.

5. Excitement and suggestibility. The behavior of people in a crowd is usually spontaneous, highly emotional, and easily influenced, which suggests that individuals in such gatherings are suggestible in nature.

6. The psychology of crowd behavior. An individual often behaves differently when acting alone than when in a crowd. Psychologists such as Le Bon have explained this phenomenon through the concepts of "group mind" or "mob mind". Individuals in a crowd become particularly sensitive to mutual stimulation and suggestion, which excites them and intensifies their emotions. The use of external symbols such as drums, trumpets, flags, banners, placards, slogans, and songs may help the crowd to obtain a high level of emotional response.

The behavior of an individual also depends on the size of the crowd. In most cases, this leads to a loss of personal identity and irresponsible behavior. A crowd is generally seen as a group of people who are highly emotional, easily influenced, and capable of acting quickly. It is also seen as a group that is trusting, irrational, instinctive, uncritical, and often destructive rather than constructive. Such a group is self-aware, spontaneous, uncontrolled, transient, and has no culture or tradition of its own. However, it should be remembered that a crowd is not always a source of danger or hostility.

Public

The public is a special type of unorganized social group. According to Ginzburg, the word "public" means a loosely connected group of people who share the same ideas or interests, but who are too close to each other to have direct personal contact with each other. People in a public do not necessarily have to be physically close to each other. The influence between them can be called "non-contact contagion". The exact boundaries of a public depend on the context, determined by the subject under consideration. For example, the public in elections is made up

of registered voters; for a religious person, it may include all his followers or devotees; for a businessman, it may be the people who buy the goods he manufactures. Thus, the public is a network of social interactions between loosely connected groups who are united by common problems. These networks of social interaction can be found in different fields - work, entertainment, politics, economics, education, religion, art, literature.

Characteristics

- ✡ Geographically dispersed network - Publics are individuals spread over wide areas who are not connected by physical proximity or direct, face-to-face interaction.
- ✡ Indirect and impersonal relationships - Members do not share personal ties; their relationships are largely abstract and mediated through communication channels.
- ✡ Mass media communication - Communication occurs through mass media such as newspapers, radio, television, journals, telephones, postal services, cinema, and public speeches, which facilitate information exchange and group cohesion.
- ✡ Rational and critical discussion - Publics serve as a forum for discussion and debate of ideas, where decisions are usually based on rational thinking and critical analysis.
- ✡ Potential for media influence - Overreliance on mass communication can make the public vulnerable to emotional manipulation or persuasion through repetitive or biased messages, undermining rational discourse.

Difference between Public and crowd

Public	**Crowd**
Membership in the public does not require physical co-location; individuals are connected ideologically or thematically rather than spatially.	The crowd is fundamentally defined by physical co-presence; its formation and dynamics depend on members being gathered in close spatial proximity.
An individual may simultaneously belong to multiple publics- for instance, as a consumer, voter, religious adherent, or professional- each defined by distinct interests or issues.	An individual can typically participate in only one crowd at any given moment, due to the situational and location-bound nature of crowd behavior.
Due to its dispersed and often large-scale nature, the transmission of ideas within the public tends to be slower compared to tightly-knit or face-to-face groups.	Communication within a crowd occurs rapidly and often non-verbally, facilitated by immediate sensory cues, emotional contagion, and collective excitement.
The public is characterized by a relatively higher degree of rational deliberation and lower susceptibility to emotional contagion. It provides a legitimate space for open debate, reasoned disagreement, and critical discourse.	Crowds are marked by high suggestibility, emotional intensity, and impulsivity. Rational deliberation is minimal, and there is little to no opportunity for structured debate or dissent.
Publics are governed by shared norms and expectations, which often lead to the formation of formal or informal	Lacking established norms or institutional frameworks, crowd behavior tends to be spontaneous, unregulated, and highly

organizations. As a result, collective behavior within the public tends to be more structured, consistent, and predictable.	volatile - often resulting in actions that are erratic, unpredictable, and potentially aggressive or violent.

Difference between organized and Unorganized group

Organized groups	**Unorganized group**
Organized groups are characterized by a deliberate structural framework.	Unorganized groups lack formal structure or institutional organization.
Examples include trade unions, political parties, religious institutions, and professional associations.	Common examples include crowds, mobs, audiences, and the public-all of which emerge without central coordination or hierarchy.
These groups are intentionally formed to advance specific collective goals or interests, whether economic, ideological, social, or cultural in nature.	These groups are not purposefully created; rather, they typically form spontaneously in response to situational stimuli, shared environments, or common focal points (e.g., an event, issue, or location).
Social interaction among members follows established patterns- interactions are systematic, regulated, and predictable, contributing to stable group dynamics.	Social interaction within unorganized groups is irregular and unpatterned. As a result, collective behavior-particularly in volatile formations like crowds or mobs- tends to be erratic and difficult to predict.
Each organized group operates according to its own set of clearly defined social norms, which guide member behaviour and maintain internal cohesion.	Established social norms are either absent or weakly enforced, leading to fluid, context-dependent conduct that may deviate significantly from conventional expectations.
Such groups exhibit a discernible internal structure, which may vary in complexity-ranging from simple and informal arrangements to highly formalized, hierarchical systems.	Such groups generally lack a defined internal structure. Even in relatively stable forms like "the public," structural boundaries remain ambiguous and shifting, depending on context or issue.
Members typically share a common understanding of the group's purpose and often collaborate purposefully to achieve shared objectives, demonstrating cooperation and role differentiation.	Since members often lack clearly aligned or sustained interests, coordinated action or long-term cooperation is uncommon — collective goals rarely emerge organically.
Compared to unorganized aggregates (e.g., crowds or publics), organized groups demonstrate greater longevity and institutional stability.	Most unorganized groups- especially crowds and mobs- are transient by nature, dissolving as quickly as they form, with no enduring institutional presence.

Certain primary or enduring groups- such as family, religious communities, or lifelong professional associations- may exert profound and lasting influence on an individual's personality and identity, largely due to their formalized membership and continuous involvement in one's life.	These groups seldom play a continuous or defining role in an individual's life. Their influence on personality development is minimal, largely because membership is informal, temporary, and often passive or incidental.

F) Classification based on interest

Charles A. Ellwood, in his *"Psychology of Human Society"*, distinguishes social groups into three distinct classes, namely, Involuntary and voluntary groups, Institutional and non-institutional groups, Temporary and permanent groups.

• Involuntary groups are those into which individuals are born or join against their will. These groups are based on gender, age, or race, such as family, city, state, community, caste, and ethnicity.

• However, voluntary groups are groups that individuals decide to join his own will, for examples include political parties, trade unions, youth organizations, religious organizations, and cultural groups.

• Institutional groups, such as the church, state, caste, and schools, are usually permanent, while non-institutional groups are temporary and include crowds, mobs, audiences, and the general public. This type of group have only temporary nature.

G) Classification o groups based on the duration of contact

Some sociologists distinguish between groups based on the length of their contact:

- Ephemeral or Chance Groups: These are temporary groups formed through short-term or incidental interactions. For example, people waiting together at a bus stop form an ephemeral group.
- Enduring Groups: These are groups that last over a longer period of time, such as a peer group.

Other Types of Groups

❖ **Reference Group**

The concept of "reference group" was formally introduced by Muzafer Sherif in 1948, who published it in his textbook *'An Outline of Social Psychology'*. Sharif used the term to distinguish between groups to which an individual is a member (membership groups) and groups to which an individual's attitudes or behaviour are influenced by others without formal affiliation. These two types may sometimes overlap, but their functions are analytically distinct.

They can be a group that an individual actually wants to be a part of or a social category that conforms to norms.

The concept of reference group is illustrated from the perspective of sociologists, as people are influenced not only by the groups to which they belong, but also by their views of other groups, even if they are not members of the latter. These external groups have a passive influence on individual behaviour, sometimes without direct interaction; they derive their power from being mentally referenced as standards for comparison or goals. Importantly, such groups do not necessarily exist as reference groups; The term is only applied to the extent that they act as sources of influence on a person's attitudes, values, or behaviour.

For example, in a child's development, the family, consisting of the child's parents and siblings, simultaneously functions as a dual group: the child wants to be liked, imitates the reactions of the parents and siblings, and behaves like them. But as the individual grows, this process becomes more selective. The individual begins to identify with certain external groups whose values, opinions, or likes are particularly desirable and to direct his or her behaviour toward them. At this stage, the distinction between a membership group and a reference group becomes analysable and significant to the individual. One may not be a member of a particular group socially or institutionally, but it can still have an impact on shaping the individual's identity, dreams, and social behaviour.

The distinction between reference groups and membership groups is particularly relevant in today's world, which is full of complex and diverse social landscapes- especially in countries where people are mobile and have a high degree of occupational mobility. In such cases, people may be official members of one group (such as their job, neighbourhood, or ethnic community) but may even seek to join a group that they consider more suitable for them.

On the other hand, in small, traditional, or nomadic societies, where social roles are more fixed, communities are tight, and people's mobility is limited, the line between membership and reference groups is often blurred or completely blurred. In these societies, the groups to which one belongs are usually the main sources of normative influence, thus reducing the need for external references.

- **Gemeinschaft (Community) and Gesellschaft (Society/Association)**

The German sociologist Ferdinand Tönnies distinguished two different types of social group: Gemeinschaft (community) and Gesellschaft (Society/Association). This distinction can be seen in both types of social groups and societies. Gemeinschaft are intimate, personal, and exclusive relationships where people treat each other as complete human beings. Such individuals can fulfill a wide range of their personal and social needs within the group.

Typical examples of Gemeinschaft are families, relatives, neighbourhoods, rural villages, and circles of friends, where the relationship is close, friendly, and personal. According to Tönnies, Gesellschaft (Association) is a term that refers to social partnerships that people intentionally form, usually with economic or other utilitarian goals in mind. The relationships involved are not personal or emotional, but specific, partial, and goal-oriented. These can be business contracts, legal agreements, corporations, cities, and towns, in which individuals become part

of a group to achieve certain goals, so they are not fully involved in group life. Community (Gemeinschaft) is created and maintained by love and trust, while Gesellschaft (Association) is made up of mutually beneficial rational agreements. Tönnies's classification is similar to the distinction between primary and secondary groups in sociology.

❖ Open or closed groups

Another possibility is to classify groups as open or closed.

- Open groups are groups that have voluntary membership and allow mobility. For example, a football club that is an open group may have members leaving and new members joining, so that the group can survive. Open groups contribute greatly to the personal development of their members.
- In contrast, closed groups have limited membership and limited scope for member mobility. Membership is very difficult to obtain, as in a caste group or an exclusive club, where membership is restricted to a few.

❖ Territorial groups and non-territorial groups

Park and Burgess distinguished social groups based on their relationship to space. The first category includes groups that are associated with a specific geographical area, such as societies or states, while the second includes non-territorial groups, which are not limited by space and can be entities such as social classes, castes, crowds, and publics.

❖ Genetic groups and congregate group

Based on the origin and willingness of groups, F. Q. Giddings proposed a different classification. Genetic groups are those that a person is born into. Such groups include family groups, ethnic groups, and racial groups. In contrast, congregate groups are voluntary, so individuals are free to join or not; examples of such groups include political parties, trade unions, and other associations.

❖ Natural and Formed Groups

Natural groups are those in which members come together spontaneously as a result of naturally occurring events, personal attraction, or shared needs. Examples of such groups include families, peer groups, and street gangs.

Formed groups, on the other hand, are the result of external influence or intervention, usually formed to achieve a specific goal. Examples include therapy groups, encounter groups, committees, and work teams.

❖ Formal and Informal Groups

• Formal groups are those that are intentionally created to achieve some organizational goals or to complete tasks. They are usually large and can be permanent or temporary, depending on the nature of the work or the goals to be achieved.

• Informal groups, on the other hand, come into existence as a result of communication and interaction between people at social and psychological levels. Such groups are formed on the

basis of individual preferences, not as a result of assigned tasks. For example, employees working in a company may organize a cricket match on the weekend; here the main objective is social interaction, and work-related tasks are merely incidental.

❖ **Homogeneous and Heterogeneous Groups**

• Homogeneous groups are those whose members have similar academic, social, and emotional backgrounds, and therefore the group is characterized by a high degree of homogeneity.

• In a heterogeneous group, members differ in age, academic level, interests, needs, or other characteristics, thus creating a diverse mix in the group.

❖ **Treatment Groups and Task Groups**

• Therapeutic groups are generally created with the aim of meeting the social and emotional needs of their members. They provide education, support, therapy, personal growth and socialization through their activities.

• However, task groups are those that are established with the aim of achieving a specific goal but serves a wider area or constituency.

Conclusion

Groups represent the core layers of human society, and every individual is a member of at least one group. Studying group behaviour is a prerequisite for understanding society, since interactions between groups are an indication of social structure. The type of group depends on the closeness of its members and the frequency of interaction.

A social group consists of individuals who share the same goals, beliefs, or interests. What distinguishes a group from a mere collection of people is the possession of the former's social cohesion. Sometimes members share characteristics such as values, interests, social or ethnic background, or collective representation.

Check Your Progress

MCQ

1. Which of the following is not a type of group?

A) Aggregate group B) Associational group

C) Temperament group D) Societal group

2. A well organised group with written rules and structure is called

A) Associational group B) Social group

C) Aggregate group D) Societal group

3. According to Anderson and parker, the distinctive bond of a group is ……?

A) Reciprocal interaction B) Conflict

C) Shared culture D) Norms and rules

4. Peer groups, neighbourhood groups, clubs are example of ……..

A) Social group B) Societal groups

C) Aggregate groups D) Associational groups

5. Smallest type of social group is ……..

A) Dyad B) Crowd

C) Public D) Community

6. Who defined "By group, we mean any collection of human beings who are brought into social relationship with one another"?

A) MacIver B) Gillin and Gillin

C) GH Mead D) Karl Manheim

7. which of the following is not a characteristics of social group?

A) we feeling B) Common interests

C) Different interests D) Groups are dynamics

8. George Simmel classified social groups into ……

A) Small groups and large groups B) Voluntary and Involuntary groups

C) Primary and secondary groups D) Vertical and Horizontal groups

9. Which of the following not a social groups classified by Sanderson?

A) Involuntary groups B) Voluntary groups

C) Delegated groups D) Vertical groups

10. Who introduced the concept of primary groups?

A) CH Cooley B) W Green

C) Lundberg D) Nimkoff

11. Find out an example for primary group

A) Family B) Factories

C) Labour Union D) National political party

12. Which of the following book written by CH Cooley?

A) Social organization: Human nature and social order

B) Psychology of human society

C) Folkways

D) An outline of social psychology

13. Which of the following is a characteristics of secondary groups?

A) Sense of belonging B) Emotional attachments

C) Impersonal relationship D) Cooperation

14. The book 'Folkways' written by

A) WG Sumner B) CH Cooley

C) Muzafer Sherif D) MacIver

15. Pitirim Sorokin classified social group into

A) Horizontal and vertical groups B) Primary and Secondary groups
C) Organized and Unorganized groups D) Voluntary and Involuntary groups

16. A person becomes a member of a group based on his own will, it refers to

A) Voluntary group B) In group

C) Primary Group D) All of the above

17. Delegated groups refers to

A) A group of individual only as representative of others

B) A group formed on the basis of intimacy level

C) Member of a group on the basis of his own will

D) A group formed on the basis of incidental interactions

18. The …….. is primarily used for explain the members who are alike in their status or positions in the society.

A) Horizontal group B) Out groups

C) Unorganized groups D) Vertical group

19. Which of the following is a groups depicts the interactions of members with a sense of unity and support?

A) In groups B) Out groups

C) Unorganized groups D) Ephemeral groups

20. Find out an example for Horizontal groups

A) Occupational groups B) Family

C) Social classes D) Bureaucracy

21. Find out odd one

A) Crowd B) Family

C) Peer group D) Neighbourhood

22. ……. are temporary groups formed through short-term or incidental interactions

A) Ephemeral group B) In group

C) Involuntary group D) Enduring group

23. The term ‘reference group’ introduced by?

A) Muzafer Sherif B) WG Sumner

C) CH Cooley D) MacIver

24. The book 'An Outline of Social Psychology' written by?

A) Muzafer Sherif B) WG Sumner

C) MacIver D) Bogardus

25. Ferdinand Tonnies classified social groups into ……..?

A) Gemeinschaft and Gesellschaft B) Genetic and Congregate groups

C) Natural and Formed groups D) Voluntary and Involuntary groups

26. Find out an example for congregate groups

A) Family B) Religious group

C) Caste D) Political Party

Short note

1. Define social group

2. List out two characteristics of social group

3. Write a short note on primary group

4. Mention any four characteristics of primary groups

5. What do you mean by secondary group?

6. Give two examples of secondary groups

7. Define In groups and Out groups

8. Define reference groups

9. List out major forms of groups

10. Differentiate between involuntary and voluntary groups with suitable example

11. Define delegate groups

12. Differentiate between Horizontal and Vertical groups

13. Define unorganized group with suitable examples

14. Briefly discuss the concept of Gemeinschaft and Gesellschaft.

Short essay

1. 'Social group have any importance in social life'? substantiate your answer with appropriate example

2. Explain the advantages and disadvantages of a group.

3. Describe the concept of primary groups and their characteristics.

4. Discuss the importance of secondary groups in the social life

5. Discuss organized and unorganized groups in the social life with suitable examples

Essay

1. Define social groups and discuss their major types with suitable examples.

2. Compare and contrast the characteristics, functions, and importance of primary and secondary groups.

3. ‘Different social groups in the society are the foundation of social life and personality development’, Elaborate your answer with examples.

MCQ Answers

1. C) Temperament group
2. A) Associational group
3. A) Reciprocal interaction
4. A) Social group
5. A) Dyad
6. A) MacIver
7. C) Different interests
8. A) Small groups and large groups
9. D) Vertical groups
10. A) CH Cooley
11. A) Family
12. A) Social organization: Human nature and social order
13. C) Impersonal relationship
14. A) WG Sumner
15. A) Horizontal and vertical groups
16. A) Voluntary group
17. A) A group of individual only as representative of others
18. A) Horizontal group
19. A) In groups
20. A) Occupational groups
21. A) Crowd
22. A) Ephemeral group
23. A) Muzafer Sherif
24. A) Muzafer Sherif
25. A) Gemeinschaft and Gesellschaft
26. D) Political Party

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